



A FREE TOOLKIT FROM TENDAI · BETWEEN WORLDS

The Diaspora Money Boundaries Toolkit

Give without bleeding yourself dry.

The exact words to say no to family requests — without guilt, and without breaking the bond. A simple budget frame, ready-to-use scripts, and the five-step method for giving from strength instead of from guilt.

YOUR FREE COMPANION TO *THE MONEY BETWEEN US*

START HERE

You are not alone, and you are not ungrateful

If you send money home and feel a quiet knot in your stomach every time the phone rings — this toolkit is for you.

You are part of one of the largest movements of love and money on earth. Africans in the diaspora send home around **one hundred billion US dollars a year** — in many countries, more than all official foreign aid combined. What you do is heroic. You are a lifeline.

But a lifeline, wrapped the wrong way, can quietly become a leash — taking your savings, your peace, and your health, a little each month. This toolkit gives you the first, most practical tools to keep the lifeline and loosen the leash: to give in a way you can sustain for thirty years, not thirty months.

What's inside

1. The CLEAR Method — the five steps, on one page.
2. Your Real Number — a simple exercise to see what you truly give.
3. The Giving Line — a budget frame to decide what you give, in advance.
4. The Scripts — the exact words for the hard conversations.
5. Your First Step — one thing to do this week.

Work it with a pen in hand. Reading about change will not change anything — doing the exercises will. Be gentle with yourself, and go at your own pace.

A note: I am not a financial adviser, doctor, or therapist, and this toolkit is general guidance drawn from lived experience and research — not financial or medical advice. For decisions about your own money or health, please consult a qualified professional.

THE WHOLE METHOD, ON ONE PAGE

The CLEAR Method

Five steps from money chaos and guilt to calm, boundaried, sustainable giving. When the guilt rises, come back here.

C**Count it**

Know your true number. You cannot heal what you will not look at.

L**Lift the lie**

Dismantle the four stories that trap you: love-equals-money; they-cannot-survive-without-me; I-must-hide-my-struggle; one-no-erases-everything.

E**Establish the line**

Decide your giving in advance, as a fixed number, while you are calm — not in the heat of a request.

A**Announce it with love**

Tell your family the truth, wrapped in love and offered early — before the limit arrives as a surprise.

R**Rebuild from strength**

Secure your own foundation, and give in ways that free rather than merely feed. You cannot pour from an empty cup.

Remember

The point is never to give less. It is to give from strength instead of guilt — so your love can flow for a lifetime without destroying you.

THE C IN CLEAR

Your Real Number

Most of us have never once added it up. The fog lets the thing grow in the dark. Turn on the light.

Gather your bank statements and every money-transfer app for the last twelve months. Write down everything — the regular sends AND the emergencies, top-ups, and cash you gave.

What I send in a typical month

Regular monthly support

Average extra / emergencies (monthly)

My monthly number

The bigger picture

Monthly number $\times$ 12 = my yearly number

Yearly number $\times$ years I've been giving

Now, one honest sentence

"What seeing this number makes me feel is..."

Do not judge the number. It is not a verdict on your character — just information, like a reading on a thermometer. Seeing it clearly is the first act of love, for them and for you.

THE E IN CLEAR

Your Giving Line

Decide what you give in advance, while calm — not in the heat of a phone call, when guilt is loudest and wisdom is lowest.

Build it from the bottom up. Most of us send first and live on what's left. We flip that: your own foundation comes first, then you give generously from what genuinely remains.

My monthly income (household) _____

– Essentials (rent, food, transport, bills, min. debt) _____

– My foundation (emergency fund + savings) _____

– A little for living (rest, joy) _____

= My giving pool _____

From inside that pool, I choose my line:

My family-support line

I will send _____ per month, on the _____ of each month.

For genuine emergencies, I can give up to _____ across the whole year, over and above my line.

This is not cruelty. It is the most generous number you can give *forever* — which, over a lifetime, is far larger than the most you can give until you collapse.

THE A IN CLEAR

The Words You've Been Looking For

Truth, wrapped in love — not a complaint. Adapt each into your own voice and language; the spirit matters more than the words.

SETTING YOUR REGULAR LINE

"Mama, I want to talk honestly, because I love you and want to keep helping you for many years — not just this year. Life here costs far more than it looks from home. So I've worked out what I can send every month, properly, without trouble: it's [amount], on [date], every month. You can count on it. I'd rather promise something real and keep it than promise more and let you down."

RESPONDING TO A NEW REQUEST

"I hear you, and I truly want to help. Honestly, I've already set aside what I can for the family this month, and it's fully committed. I can't add to it without putting my own household at risk. Let's think together about how to solve this — maybe across the wider family — rather than it falling on me alone."

WHEN YOU'RE CAUGHT OFF GUARD

"Let me look at what's possible and come back to you tomorrow."

MEETING THE GUILT-TRIP

"You're right, and I'm grateful every single day. And it's because I'm grateful that I want to keep helping you for the long road, in a way I can actually sustain."

THE R IN CLEAR

One Thing to Do This Week

You cannot pour from an empty cup. Building your own foundation is not selfish — it is what lets you keep helping for life.

Don't try to do everything at once. Pick the boxes you'll tackle this week:

- ☐ **Count it.** Sit down and find your real number (page 3).
- ☐ **Open a savings account** just for your emergency fund. Name it something that steadies you.
- ☐ **Set up one small automatic transfer** into it on payday — automatic, so willpower is never required.
- ☐ **Decide your line** using the budget frame (page 4) — with your partner, if you have one.
- ☐ **Plan one honest conversation** using a script (page 5).

A word from Tendai

"Looking at the number is not betraying your family. Hiding from it is how good people quietly drown while smiling on the family WhatsApp group. Turn on the light — in love for them, and, for once, in love for yourself too."

If money worry is stealing your sleep or your peace, please talk to someone — a trusted person, your doctor, or a free financial counselling service in your country. Reaching for help is strength, not weakness.

GO DEEPER

This is just the beginning.

This toolkit is drawn from the full book — where every step has its stories, its evidence, and the deeper work of lifting the guilt for good.

The Money Between Us
by Tendai Makanda

Get the book, join the list for honest letters from the diaspora, and be first to hear the podcast:

tendaibetweenworlds.com

Two worlds. One honest voice.